ual:

RESEARCH
DEGREES

Post-Registration Research Ethics Approval Form

Guidance:

- **Please ensure that you have read the '*UAL Guidance for Research Ethics Approval'* and '*UAL Code of Practice on Research Ethics'* before completing this form**. All supporting documentation on research ethics can be found in the UAL Research Degrees section on Moodle
- Please complete this form electronically
- **Section A and Appendix 1** (if applicable) are to be completed by the student and supervisors
- **Section B** is for UAL Committee use only
- Once Section A (and Appendix 1 if necessary) has been completed, including all necessary signatures, the form should be submitted to researchdegrees@arts.ac.uk by the student
- Incomplete forms, including any that are missing signatures, will be returned to the student for completion

SECTION A — TO BE COMPLETED BY THE STUDENT

Name:	**JENNIFER SYKES**
College:	**CREATIVE COMPUTING INSTITUTE**

1. Please provide a 100-word summary of your proposed research. Explain in terms appropriate to a layperson.

A study testing a newly developed physical prototype for teaching creative coding and physical computing. Students can opt to use this toolkit to aid their physical computing prototyping in a 10-week curricula project, providing quantitative and qualitative feedback on its use.

This is an optional longitudinal study that does not impact upon the student project brief, assessment or the resulting course work of the curriculum. The role of the toolkit is to facilitate understanding and comprehension of physical computing circuitry. It does not impact concept development or the five UAL assessment criteria of knowledge, enquiry, process, realisation and communication. Students that opt out are not penalised for doing so and students that opt in gain no additional assessment award.

Student feedback will be provided anonymously via online forms embedded in web pages. Protected criteria under GDPR will not be collected with the exception of students names so that data can be logged over the duration of the long study. Names will be converted to encrypted numbers at the point of submission before being stored on a server. This means no protected criteria is publicly available at any stage.

2. Does your research involve participants

	No*
X	Yes

***If you answer 'No', you do not need to complete Questions 3 to 12, instead please go to Question 13 and continue from there.**

3. Who will the participants be? Please tick as appropriate.	
X	Students at the University
	Staff at the University
	Other*
***If you answered 'Other' please specify below**	

4. How will participants be recruited and how many will be involved?

Participants will be asked to actively consent to the study by signing up via an online form outside of class time. The structure of the study, what happens to their data will be explained via this form and via an in-person announcement.

The participants polled will be from the Diploma in Creative Coding. Whilst these students will be participating in this research during their physical computing module class hours, they will be required to actively consent outside of this class time to allow sufficient time to understand what is being asked without pressure on in-class constraints. They will also have a point of contact that is not the lead researcher should they wish to opt out of the study or have any concerns during the process.

Students can opt out of participating at any time by not completing the feedback forms or using a toolkit in class. If they have not actively consented, they will not be asked to use the toolkit during class and alternative teaching exercises will be provided in parallel that do not impede student comprehension or level of understanding. It is predicted a third of the class cohort will participate (around 30 participants)

5. What will participants be asked to do? Explain in terms appropriate to a layperson.

In the initial stage of the study:
Participants are asked to undertake 5 practical tasks that implement the theory of Functional Errors.
Participants are asked to use the practical toolkit (Feedback Shield) to implement aid the understanding of Functional Errors in physical computing.

They are then asked to provide quantitative and qualitative feedback after each task. On average there will be 2 tasks per week.

In the second stage of the study:
Participants are asked again to actively consent and opt in to using the Feedback Shield in the development of

independent project work. However, the use of the Feedback Shield will have no impact upon assessment and this will be made clear to participants .

6. What potential risks to the interests of participants do you foresee and what steps will you take to minimise those risks? A participant's interests include their physical and psychological well-being, their commercial interests; and their rights of privacy and reputation.

As the participants will be participating in the longitudinal study during a curriculum module, careful consideration has to be placed on how they consent to the study. As per section 5 of the guidelines, participants may feel the power imbalance of the lead research also being their tutor removes the full autonomy to consent. Participants may also feel that the study occurring during class time impedes their ability to opt-out.

As per discussion with Nicole Palmer (Research Ethics and Integrity Manager), the following mitigations will be implemented to ensure parity and autonomy throughout the process.

- By employing opt-in recruitment : Participants must actively opt-in to consent to the study via a sign-up form that is introduced outside of the taught classroom environment. This requires students interested in participation to initiate contact with the investigator not the other way round.
- It will be made it clear that participation is voluntary and will not affect students' progress or subsequent learning experiences in the programme and reassuring them that there will be no disadvantage to non-participation.
- A discussion of the risks and benefits of the study will be carried out with participants prior to seeking their consent. Students will be informed of the purpose of the study, time commitment, extent of disclosure that is expected of them, any risks inherent in their participation, the names of the researchers who will have access to the data, and their rights as research participants to refuse to answer any questions.
- Participation will be anonymised.
- Protecting student confidentiality by ensuring the data is rendered anonymous by an intermediary or automated process before it is analysed by the lead researcher, to maintain student confidentiality.
- Involving an intermediary who is not in a direct relationship with the students to provide information about the study and be the point of contact for any concern, thus distancing myself from the process.
- Students will not be required to participate in research as a course requirement, and a comparable non-research alternative is offered during class time.
- The content of each task is closely related to what the students will be learning as part of the course and therefore alternative activities provided will not leave any participant opting out of the study at a disadvantage.
- As the teaching tool in development is experimental, and not accepted as usual practice, it will not form part of the students' assessment, and participation in the study will be separate to the assessed element of the students' teaching.
- There could be a threat to the integrity of the data, especially in qualitative data collection, where participants do not feel free to provide their true opinions, or they modify them through fear of causing offence or affecting the ongoing relationship. This will be mitigated by anonymising all data collection.

Continued collection of consent.
In a longitudinal study extending over a length of time, a process of continuing consent will be used, whereby participants are re-informed about the study at each data collection point and asked to indicate their continued willingness to participate.

This will occur each week with an additional formal opting in process via sign-up occurring at week 6 before participants engage in independent use of the Feedback Shield in their process. Should it become apparent the Feedback Shield is making a participant's process more difficult, adding extra unnecessary workload or obstructing the students' learning in some way then the participant can cease participating in the study. The lead researcher, support staff and main point of contact will actively monitor this and withdraw participants should this become apparent.

Students (individuals or groups) are not selected solely on the basis of convenience when they would not otherwise be appropriate for inclusion. A primary question of this research is how the Feedback Shield facilitates comprehension for those using creative coding having an existing disciplinary practice and language around their preferred medium. Diploma students fit this criteria, whereas Computer Science students do not.

7. What potential risks do you foresee to yourself as the researcher and what steps will you take to minimise those risks? E.g. does your research raise issues of personal safety for you or others involved in the project, especially if taking place outside working hours or off University premises.

No safety risks I can forsee.

As the lead researcher that is also their tutor I will closely monitor the active opting-in of consent. A main point of contact that is not myself will be provided to students so any concerns can be relayed without concern or conflict with the tutor|student relationship.

I will observe the students' ability to participate in the study with the risks mentioned in part 6. If I believe a student is struggling but has not mentioned it themselves I will opt to discuss withdrawl from the study. This study should and will not put any students' curricula and assessment at risk.

8. Please attach a copy of proposed written consent form and information sheet to be given to participants. If you are not obtaining written consent or supplying an information sheet, please explain the reasons for this.

Consent will be obtained via an entry survey using Microsoft Forms and UAL one drive.

The information and consent is as follows:

This workshop is part of my PhD research as a student at the Creative Coding Institute, UAL.
Jen Sykes is conducting an enquiry into the teaching methods used when teaching Creative Coding and Physical Computing in an Art School environment. They are interested in documenting the student experience of learning to work with physical computing and the troubleshooting process involved.

Throughout this 10-week study you will have access to an Arduino shield to facilitate your troubleshooting skills. If at any stage you wish to discontinue its use you can opt out at any time. Throughout weeks 1 – 5 you will be using the Arduino Shield during short intervals in your physical computing module. During weeks 6 – 10 you can use the Arduino Shield in your independent workflows. Consent will be actively captured again at week 6 at which stage you can decide to opt-in again or opt-out of the study formally. However, you can opt out of participation and providing feedback at stage of this study formally or informally.

This survey aims to capture your consent to opt into the study, and your confidence and understanding before embarking on the study.

***Participation**:*
By taking part in the digital surveys asking your opinions you are consenting to the data being used as the basis for academic analysis.

If you choose to participate in the survey, you will be free to withdraw your participation at any point. You will not be obliged to give any reason for deciding not to take part.

Will my participation be kept confidential?
Your anonymity is very important. The data used will be kept anonymous throughout. Whilst your name is listed in a dropdown menu for you to submit feedback, this is then anonymised automatically before being stored. Therefore, your data is completely anonymised and confidental from all researchers.

You will not be identified individually anywhere in the writing up of this research. If I quote anything you have said in an interview, it will be anonymous. An example might be: 'Participant A said, 'The project is…'.'

What will happen to the results of the research project and data collected?
Analysis from the survey - including quotations from you – will contribute to an academic evaluative commentary. Your answers may also be used in academic reports, papers or conference presentations. These may appear online. However, as mentioned above your answers will remain anonymous.
Only researchers and supervisors named below will have access to the Research Data collected during this project.

External contact
Should you have any feedback or concerns during the process you may contact an external member of staff not involved in the research. They are impartial and will keep your information confidential.
Please contact :
Irti Nasar: shaikhirtiza.nasar@arts.ac.uk

Contact
I can be contacted further regarding any questions via email.
Jen Sykes, Researcher
j.sykes0620201@arts.ac.uk

Supervisors
Mick Grierson
Rebecca Fiebrink

	Please tick here if the written consent form and information sheet are attached

9. Does your project involve children or vulnerable adults? E.g. a person with a learning disability.

X	No. Go to Question 10
	Yes*
***If you answer 'Yes', you must refer to Section 4 in the '*Guidance for Research Ethics Approval*' AND obtain a Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) check (formerly known as a CRB check).**	
	I confirm that I have obtained a DBS check

10. Does your research concern groups which may be construed as terrorist or extremist?	
X	No. Go to Question 11
	Yes*
***If you answer 'Yes', you must refer to Section 5.5 in the '*Guidance for Research Ethics Approval*' AND complete the questionnaire at Appendix 1 of this form.**	

Please Note:

It is a presumption of academic research that, wherever possible and feasible, the information on which the research is based should be preserved, so that it can be made available to future researchers. However, the privacy of participants must be respected. Please refer to the guidance note on data protection before answering Question 11.

11. Will you be obtaining personal information from any of the participants? E.g. name, personal opinions, address, recorded images or audio, date of birth, notes and observations.	
	No. Go to Question 12
X	Yes*
***If you answer 'Yes', please give details. In your response, please consider:** How will you store and use this information during the course of your research? What parts of this information will need to be confidential and how? Will you exhibit or publish the information? Will you retain information after the research is concluded? If information is to be destroyed, explain why this is appropriate.	
Only Names will be stored. These will be stored on internal UAL CCI servers that adhere to GPDR compliant location. They will be converted to numerical ID before been downloaded for use analysis in further paper write ups and studies. Once downloaded the data on the server will be deleted.	

12. Will payments to participants be made?

X	No. Go to Question 13
	Yes*

*If you answer 'Yes', please state amount and whether payment is for out-of-pocket expenses or a fee.

13. If the project is to receive financial support from outside the University, please give details. Include any restrictions that have been imposed upon the conduct of the research. Please discuss this with your Director of Studies. Both financial propriety and the protection of commercial rights are important for you, the University and other third parties (e.g. sponsors, participants etc.)

14. Will any restrictions be placed on the publication of results?	
X	No. Go to Question 15
	Yes*

*If you answer 'Yes', please state the nature of the restrictions, e.g. details of any confidentiality agreement.

15. Have you attached a detailed outline of the research project to this form?	
X	Yes, the detailed outline is attached
	No

Student Declaration:

16. I confirm my responsibility to deliver the project in accordance with the Code of Practice on Research Ethics of the University of the Arts London (the University). In signing this form I am also confirming that:

a) The form is accurate to the best of my knowledge and belief.

b) There is no potential material interest that may, or may appear to, impair the independence and objectivity of researchers conducting this project.

c) I undertake to conduct the project as set out in the application unless deviation is agreed by the University and to comply with any conditions set out in the letter sent by the relevant College Research body and/or the University's Research Ethics Sub-Committee.

d) I understand and accept that the ethical propriety of this project may be monitored by the relevant College Research body and/or the University's Research Ethics Sub-Committee.

Signature of Student:	
Date *(dd/mm/yyyy):*	13.09.2023

Director of Studies Declaration:

17. I support this project and have reviewed it with the applicant.

Name:	
Signature of Director of Studies:	
Date *(dd/mm/yyyy):*	

SECTION B — FOR UAL COMMITTEE USE ONLY

Approval of Post-Registration Ethics (CRDSC):

- The College Research Degrees Sub-Committee (CRDSC) recommends that:

☐	This student's Post-Registration Ethics Approval Form is approved as **minimal ethical risk.** This decision and a copy of the form will be sent to RESC for noting at their next meeting.
☐	This student's Post-Registration Ethics Approval Form is approved as **more than minimal ethical risk** and so will be forwarded to RESC for final approval
☐	This student's Post-Registration Ethics Approval Form must be resubmitted, and the following **required** modifications should be made (*see below*)

Required Modifications List *(if applicable)*	1)		
Suggested Modifications List *(if applicable)*	1)		
Name		**Date** *(dd/mm/yyyy)*	
Signature *College Associate Dean of Research or Chair of CRDSC*			

Approval of Post-Registration Ethics (RESC):

- The Research Ethics Subcommittee (RESC) recommends that:

☐	This student's Post-Registration Ethics Approval Form is approved as **minimal ethical risk**
☐	This student's Post-Registration Ethics Approval Form is approved as **more than minimal ethical risk**
☐	This student's Post-Registration Ethics Approval Form must be resubmitted, and the following modifications should be made (see below)

Required Modifications List *(if applicable)*	1)		
Suggested Modifications List *(if applicable)*	1)		
Name		**Date** *(dd/mm/yyyy)*	
Signature *Chair of RESC*			

Completed forms should be sent to researchdegrees@arts.ac.uk

Appendix 1 - Post-Registration Research Ethics Approval Form

Please note – you only need to complete this *Appendix 1 – Post-Registration Research Ethics Approval Form* if you answered 'Yes' to Question 10 in Section A

The Terrorism Act (2006) outlaws the dissemination of records, statements and other documents that can be interpreted as promoting or endorsing terrorist acts. The University supports its researchers in undertaking research using security sensitive material, but takes seriously the need to protect them from the misinterpretation of intent by authorities, which can result in legal sanction. It is therefore important that the University is aware of the research before it begins and can ensure proper data management and oversight.

1. Does your research involve the storage on a computer of any such records, statements or other documents?	
	No
	Yes*
***If you answer 'Yes', you must respond to Question 3**	

2. Might your research involve the electronic transmission (e.g. as an email attachment) of such records or statements?	
	No
	Yes*
***If you answer 'Yes', you must respond to Question 3**	

3. If you answered 'Yes' to Questions 1 or 2, you are advised to store the relevant records or statements electronically on a secure university file store. The same applies to paper documents with the same sort of content. These should be scanned and uploaded. Access to this file store will be protected by a password unique to you. You agree to store all documents relevant to Questions 1 and 2 on that file store:	
	Yes
3a. You agree not to transmit electronically to any third party documents in the document store:	
	Yes

4. Will your research involve visits to websites that might be associated with extreme or terrorist organisations?	
	No.
	Yes*

Completed forms should be sent to researchdegrees@arts.ac.uk

***If you answer 'Yes', you must respond to Question 5**

5. If you answer 'Yes' to Question 4, you are advised that such sites may be subject to surveillance by the police. Accessing those sites from university IP addresses might lead to police enquiries. **Please acknowledge that you understand this risk by putting an 'X' in the 'Yes' box.**	
	Yes

6. By submitting to the ethics process, you accept that University Research Ethics Sub-Committee (RESC) will have access to a list of titles of documents (but not the contents of documents) in your document store. The titles will only be available to RESC. **Please acknowledge that you understand this risk by putting an 'X' in the 'Yes' box.**	
	Yes